

1. Intro to Claude

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Kerry Back
Rice Business

Same Claude, Many Doors

One model, many surfaces

- The same Claude runs behind a chat window, inside Excel, and in your terminal
- What changes is *where it runs* and *what it can touch*
- A Pro account (\$20/month) opens all of it

Today's map

- The three modes: **Chat, Cowork, Code**
- Claude Code in the terminal and in VS Code
- Claude for Excel, and choosing a model

The goal is to know which door to walk through for a given job — and what each one lets Claude do on your behalf.

The Three Modes

Chat, Cowork, Code

Chat

- The familiar chatbot
- Runs Python **in the cloud**, in a sandbox
- Upload files, download results — nothing on your machine is touched

Cowork

- Agentic work on your files
- Runs in a **virtual machine** mounted on a folder you choose
- Nothing outside that folder is visible or touchable

Code

- Claude Code, **on your computer directly**
- Runs terminal commands, installs software, reaches the internet
- The folder you open is where it starts — it can work beyond it

Same Claude, three places it can run code: the cloud, a VM, or your machine. The mode decides what it can see and touch — which is a security decision as much as a convenience one.

What Each Mode Can Touch

Capability	Chat	Cowork	Code
Run code	✓ (cloud)	✓ (VM)	✓ (your machine)
Web access	✓	—	✓
Read your local files	upload only	folder only	✓
Write / edit local files	—	folder only	✓
Run terminal commands	—	—	✓
Skills, connectors	✓	✓	✓

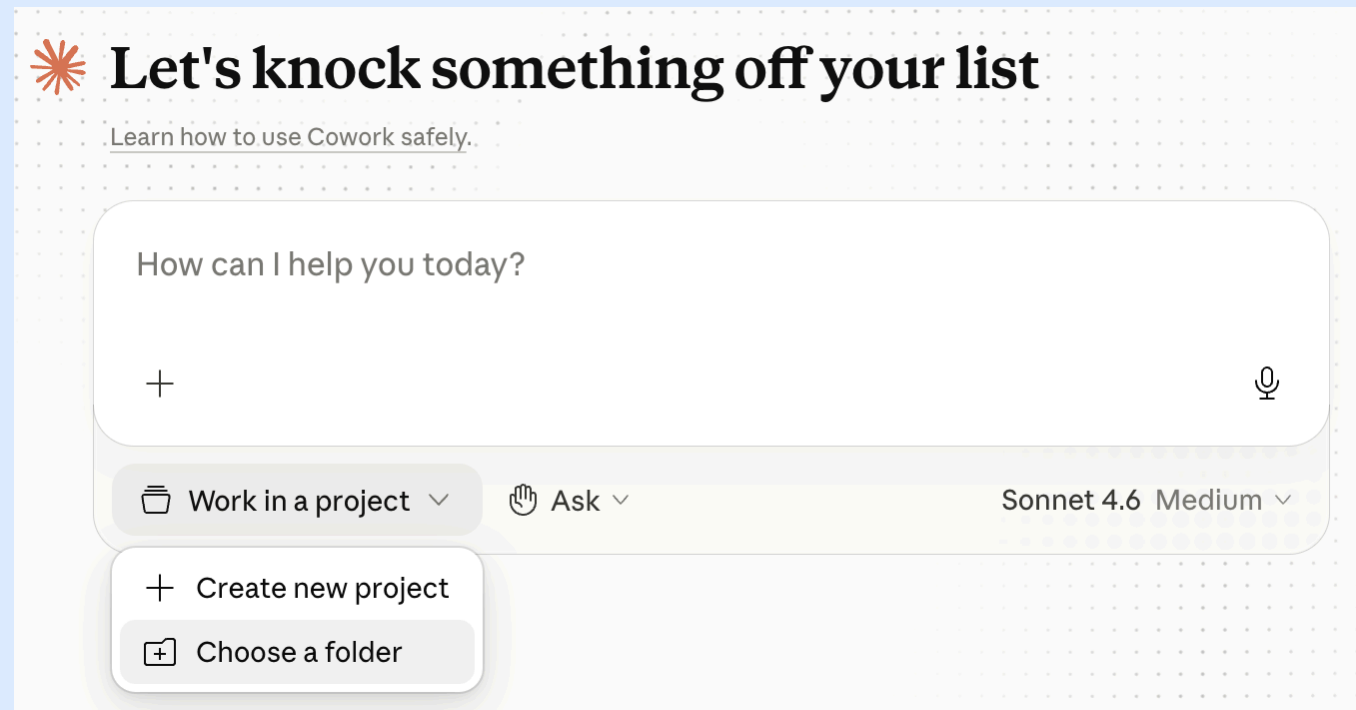
Reach grows left to right — and so does what you are trusting it with. Match the mode to the task and to the sensitivity of the data.

Opening a Folder

In Cowork and Code, you open a folder to give Claude access to your local files.

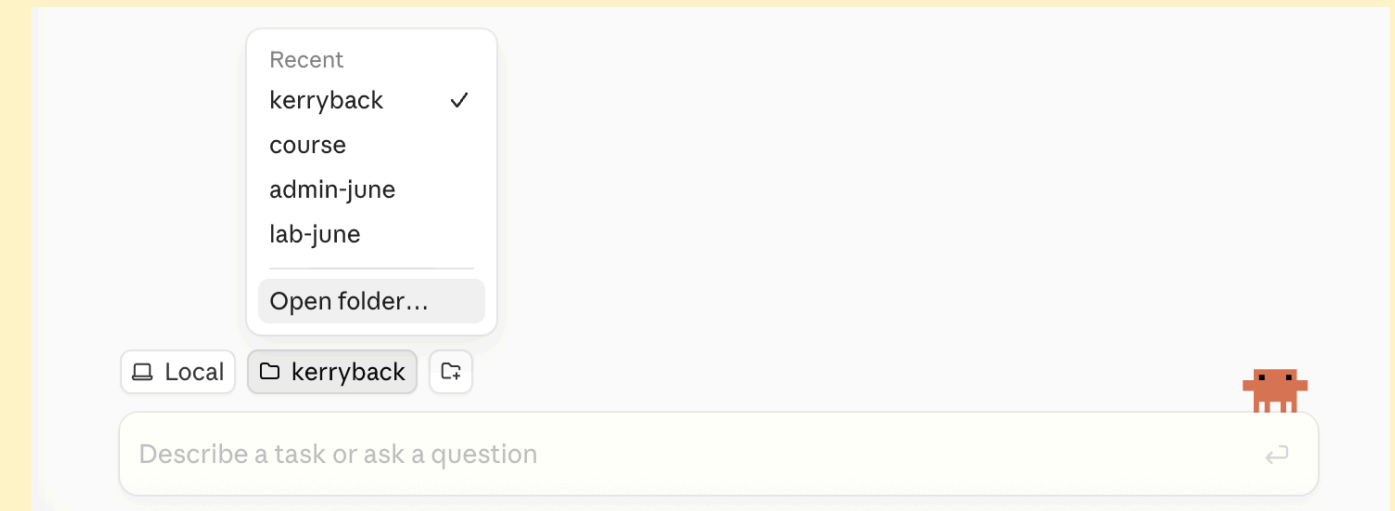
Cowork

Click *Work in a project* at the bottom of the chat, then *Choose a folder*



Code

Click the folder icon in the toolbar, or use the dropdown → *Open folder...*



Claude Code

In the Terminal and in VS Code

The `claude` command

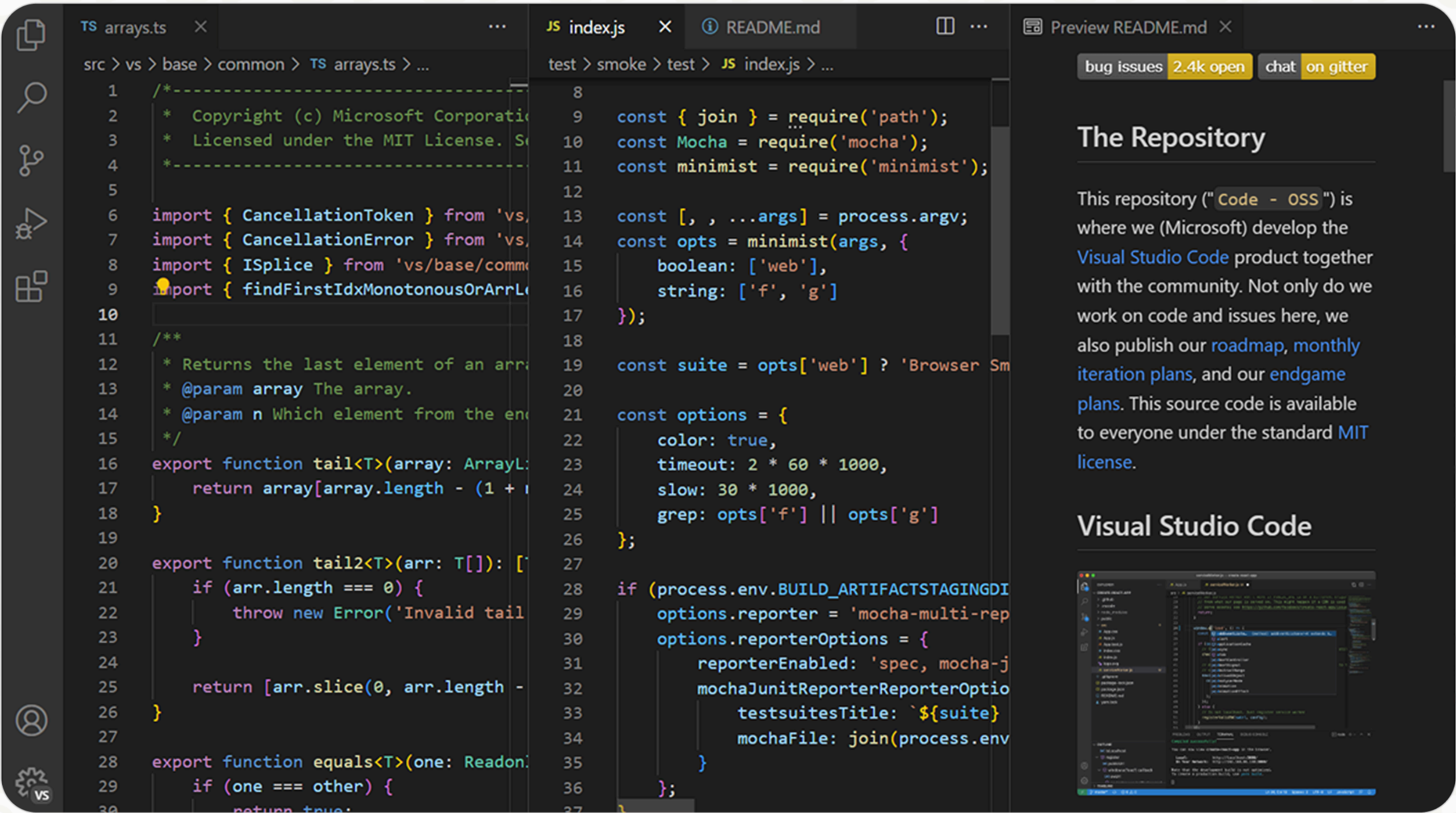
- Claude Code is also a terminal program — type `claude` and start working
- Same engine as the Code tab in Claude Desktop
- This is how developers run it, and how we deploy things

The VS Code extension

- VS Code is the standard free code editor
- The Claude extension puts Claude in a side panel, aware of your open files
- It shows proposed edits as a **diff** you approve before anything changes

For research work you will mostly live in VS Code with Claude beside you — editing scripts, running notebooks, and reviewing every change before it lands.

Claude Editing Your Code



Claude proposes a change; you see exactly what it added and removed, in green and red, and accept or reject

Claude for Excel

A Chat Panel Inside Excel

1

Mortgage Amortization Schedule

2

3

Inputs

4

Loan Amount

\$400,000

5

Annual Interest

6.500%

6

Term (Years)

30

7

Payments per

12

8

Start Date

01/01/2026

9

10

Outputs

11

Total Payment

360

12

Periodic Rate

0.5417%

13

Monthly Paym

\$2,528.27

14

Total Paid

\$910,177.95

15

Total Interest

\$510,177.95

16

17

Amortization Schedule

18

Period

Date

Beginning Balance

Payment

Principal

Interest

Ending Balance

Cumulative Interest

19

1

01/01/2026

\$400,000.00

\$2,528.27

\$361.61

\$2,166.67

\$399,638.39

\$2,166.67

20

2

02/01/2026

\$399,638.39

\$2,528.27

\$363.56

\$2,164.71

\$399,274.83

\$4,331.37

21

3

03/01/2026

\$399,274.83

\$2,528.27

\$365.53

\$2,162.74

\$398,909.30

\$6,494.11

22

4

04/01/2026

\$398,909.30

\$2,528.27

\$367.51

\$2,160.76

\$398,541.78

\$8,654.87

23

5

05/01/2026

\$398,541.78

\$2,528.27

\$369.50

\$2,158.77

\$398,172.28

\$10,813.64

24

6

06/01/2026

\$398,172.28

\$2,528.27

\$371.51

\$2,156.77

\$397,800.77

\$12,970.41

25

7

07/01/2026

\$397,800.77

\$2,528.27

\$373.52

\$2,154.75

\$397,427.26

\$15,125.16

26

8

08/01/2026

\$397,427.26

\$2,528.27

\$375.54

\$2,152.73

\$397,051.71

\$17,277.89

27

9

09/01/2026

\$397,051.71

\$2,528.27

\$377.58

\$2,150.70

\$396,674.14

\$19,428.59

28

10

10/01/2026

\$396,674.14

\$2,528.27

\$379.62

\$2,148.65

\$396,294.52

\$21,577.24

29

11

11/01/2026

\$396,294.52

\$2,528.27

\$381.68

\$2,146.60

\$395,912.84

\$23,723.84

Claude

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i

create a mortgage amortization table. assume a 30-year mortgage. allow the other parameters to be inputs.

I'll build a mortgage amortization table on Sheet1 — an inputs block (loan amount, rate, etc.) feeding a 360-month schedule for the 30-year term.

Let me set up the inputs section first.

Build inputs block in A1:B8 >

Now the calculated summary outputs:

Build outputs block in A10:B15 >

Payment of \$2,528.27/mo checks out. Now the schedule headers and the first row, then I'll fill down 360 periods.

The Claude add-in puts a chat panel directly inside Excel. You describe what you want — formulas, tables, charts, an amortization schedule — and Claude builds it in the active sheet. No Python, no terminal. Install it from the Microsoft Office Add-ins store.

Coming Day 3: Make It Yours

Skills

Teach Claude your procedures once — it follows them the same way every time

Connectors

Plug Claude into your data and systems, safely — the MCP standard

Plugins

Bundle skills and connectors into one package to share with a team

You have seen *where* Claude runs and *how* to reach it. Skills, connectors, and plugins are how you customize it to your work — they get their own session on Day 3.

Choosing a Model

Model	Best for	Cost
Haiku	Fast, simple, high-volume tasks	Lowest
Sonnet	The everyday default — fast and capable	Middle
Opus	The hardest reasoning and coding	Highest, burns quota fastest

A dropdown below the prompt lets you pick. Use Sonnet to conserve your quota; reach for Opus when a task is genuinely hard. The cheaper models are remarkably good now.

The Map

One Claude, reached through many doors: **Chat, Cowork, Code** for how much of your machine it touches; the terminal and **VS Code** for real work; and **Excel** for spreadsheets. Day 3 adds **skills, connectors, and plugins** — your procedures and your data.

Breakout

Questions to Discuss

- For your own work, which mode fits best — the sandboxed Chat, the folder-bounded Cowork, or the full-access Code?
- Where does the extra reach of Code mode make you cautious — and what would make you comfortable?
- What is the first thing you would ask the Claude panel inside Excel to build?
- When would you switch from Sonnet to Opus — and how would you know it was worth the quota?